



Microsoft beats Apple!

Microsoft regains its title as the most valuable publicly listed company.
<https://digit.in/nov21-69>



GTA remastered release date

The remastered Grand Theft Auto trilogy arrives November 11th.
<https://digit.in/nov21-78>

Google Pixel 6 and Pixel 6 Pro

Does anyone care?

Boo-Man | boo@digit.in

Most companies build hype and let out leaks on purpose. Sometimes not on purpose if the recent Samsung S22 leaks are anything to go by. But generally, the PR around phone launches is carefully managed, and peaks in interest are managed just right via news leaks, new processor benchmarks, renders, or some information or the other.

Then we have Google.

Everyone knew pretty much everything about the Pixel phones a full two months before they launched. We at Digit did a leak about the renders of the new Pixels ourselves, but in general, news came out way too fast, and so many had lost interest by the time it launched.

Personally, I couldn't be bothered about hype, because it's more about substance for me, but come on Google! And while you're at it, how about getting your act together and sorting out whatever problems prevent you from launching the phones in India! It just sucks that a company like Google cannot sell phones directly to the Indian market!

Coming to the Pixel 6 Pro, the design language seems dated. What's with everyone returning to the curved edges of the Samsung Galaxy S7 Edge! I had that phone, and it was a very cool gimmick and felt nice... in 2016! There's no need to go backwards in time unless you're going retro Google, and 5 years ago is not retro, it's plain dated.

Many reviewers and YouTubers have stated that they love the visor thing in the back that houses the cameras. They're all falling over themselves talking about how the visor being the

full width of the phone means it won't wobble about on a desk... that's like being happy you broke both your legs because the weight of the massive plasters on both of them is even!

How about we push them back to the drawing board and reward them for making cameras that actually fit into the bodies of phones, or else find a better way to incorporate the camera bumps into the phones. A

bigger battery never hurt anyone, how about making phones a little fatter with more battery life? Stretching a bump across the entire width of a phone to make it even is not exactly rocket science now is it Google? Especially when competitors are fitting all of that shooting goodness into smaller spaces and adding more capable cameras!

And look, I love Geordi La Forge from *The Next Generation* as much as any Trekkie, but will writers and YouTubers please stop comparing the 'visor' on the Pixel 6 series to the one he wore. There's literally no resemblance!

What about the insides? Apart from a new Tensor core that's probably listening to every word I say and planning to inundate me with ads for everything under the sun, and yes, does do a cool trick or two with removing unwanted subjects from the background of my photos, there's not too much to write home about. This is probably not the phone for someone into gaming. It's quite possibly not the phone for those who click a lot of pictures and videos either. Maybe it is perfect for those who like to click 9862348765123 pictures of the Milky Way by staying up until 2 am waiting for clear skies. That will get old soon though, I would imagine.



Now does that look anything like the Pixel phones? And no, neither does Cyclops from Xmen. Just enough of the bad comparisons, please!

The bottom line is, you'd buy a Pixel because you wanted to own, by far, the best smartphone camera on the market! Do you get that here? In some scenarios, yes, it's capable of outputting some of the best pictures on the planet clicked from a smartphone. It's not miles ahead of the competition like we'd expect, but it is slightly better for still pictures in general use.

However, in a few scenarios and lighting conditions, other phones can do as good if not better, even in still images. A big disappointment is video. While I'm too old to be on TikTok or shorts or IGTV or whatever it is the kids use these days, I do still find myself making videos very often. Storage is cheap, bandwidth is cheap, why limit yourself to static images? The fact that video quality is not the best here is another letdown, and the kids who live for video these days are not going to be jumping to buy this phone.

Usually, I'm just finding flaws to make a few jokes or misrepresenting a gadget's strong points as weaknesses. There's none of that here. As a one-time Google phone enthusiast (from the Nexus days), the latest lineup honestly feels like we've taken a step back, or rather, the lack of a leap forward feels like a step back.

The biggest plus point here is getting the latest Android updates, without delays, and being able to upgrade for as much as five years! I honestly doubt these phones will do the job for anyone for the next five years given their cheaper-but-not-really-cheap price tags. Overall, I expected more Google. I think so did most others. **d**